

CRAM (Change Risk Assessment Matrix)	Criteria	Low Risk (1) Safe, routine changes, with low complexity and predictable outcomes	Medium Risk (2) Moderately complex changes that require oversight, scheduling review, and leadership review	High Risk (3) Significant risk of major incidents, requires senior leadership review, stringent controls, and strategic scheduling	Score	Weighted Score
Business Impact (Weight = 3) Highest Score X 3 Biggest driver; What could this break?	System Criticality	Tier 3 or Tier 4 systems; impacts a single department	Tier 2 systems; impacts a single site or multiple departments	Tier 0 or Tier 1 systems OR impacts multiple sites / critical operations	2	6
	Customer Impact	No potential customer impact; internal-only change	Limited potential customer impact; minor service degradation or short outage	Significant potential customer impact; major outage or service disruption	1	
	Regulatory Compliance	No compliance implications	Minor compliance considerations; documented and approved	High compliance risk; regulatory breach possible if change fails	1	
Execution Risk (Weight = 2) Average Score X 2 Second driver; How hard is it to do safely?	Change Complexity	Simple change; 1–2 teams, single system, few steps, minimal risk, limited scope, predictable outcome	Moderate complexity; 3–4 teams, one complex system or minor integration	High complexity; 5+ teams, multiple systems, deep integration, unpredictable outcomes	1	3
	Testing Coverage	Fully tested, evidence available, low risk	Partially tested, failed test cases, risk acknowledged, acceptable with oversight	Untested or failed, no mitigation; high risk if deployed	1	
	Rollback Feasibility	Easy rollback; < 30 minutes	Moderate rollback; 30 min to 2 hours	Difficult rollback; > 2 hours or requires major recovery effort	2	
Operational Risk (Weight = 1) Average Score X 1 Still important, but lighter weight; Are we truly ready to run it now?	Change Window	No outage expected or within the Approved Maintenance Window	Outage occurring during Off-Hours (22:30 - 04:49) or during the weekend Soft-Freeze	Outage during Peak / Business Hours / Pre-Flight / Global Ops (05:00–17:00) or during a Hard Freeze	1	1
	Operational Readiness	All documentation, observability, approvals, and resources confirmed; support teams ready	Some gaps in documentation, observability, or readiness; mitigations in place	Significant gaps; unclear ownership or missing approvals	1	
	Vendor Dependency	No vendor involvement; fully internal	Vendor involvement for minor tasks or advisory	Vendor dependency for critical tasks; delays or coordination risks	1	
	Secure Coding	Standard Quality Gate (or higher) is used; No Critical or High vulnerabilities are present	Security Plus or Security Quality Gate is used; Unresolved security hotspots are present	No Quality Gate is configured; Critical or High vulnerabilities exist, and security hotspots remain unresolved	1	
	Resilience & Recovery (RR)	RR plan fully automated, tested successfully, and evidence demonstrating less than 1 hour total elapsed time for recovery prior to outside validation	RR plan tested and lacking full automation or with issues remediated without re-testing; Recovery process is < 2 hours total elapsed time for recovery prior to outside validation	No RR testing evidence; recovery plan unverified and/or recovery process is > 2 hours total elapsed time for recovery prior to outside validation	1	
					Legend	Total Weighted Score ->
					Low Risk: 6-10	
					Medium Risk: 11-15	
					High Risk: 16-18	10